

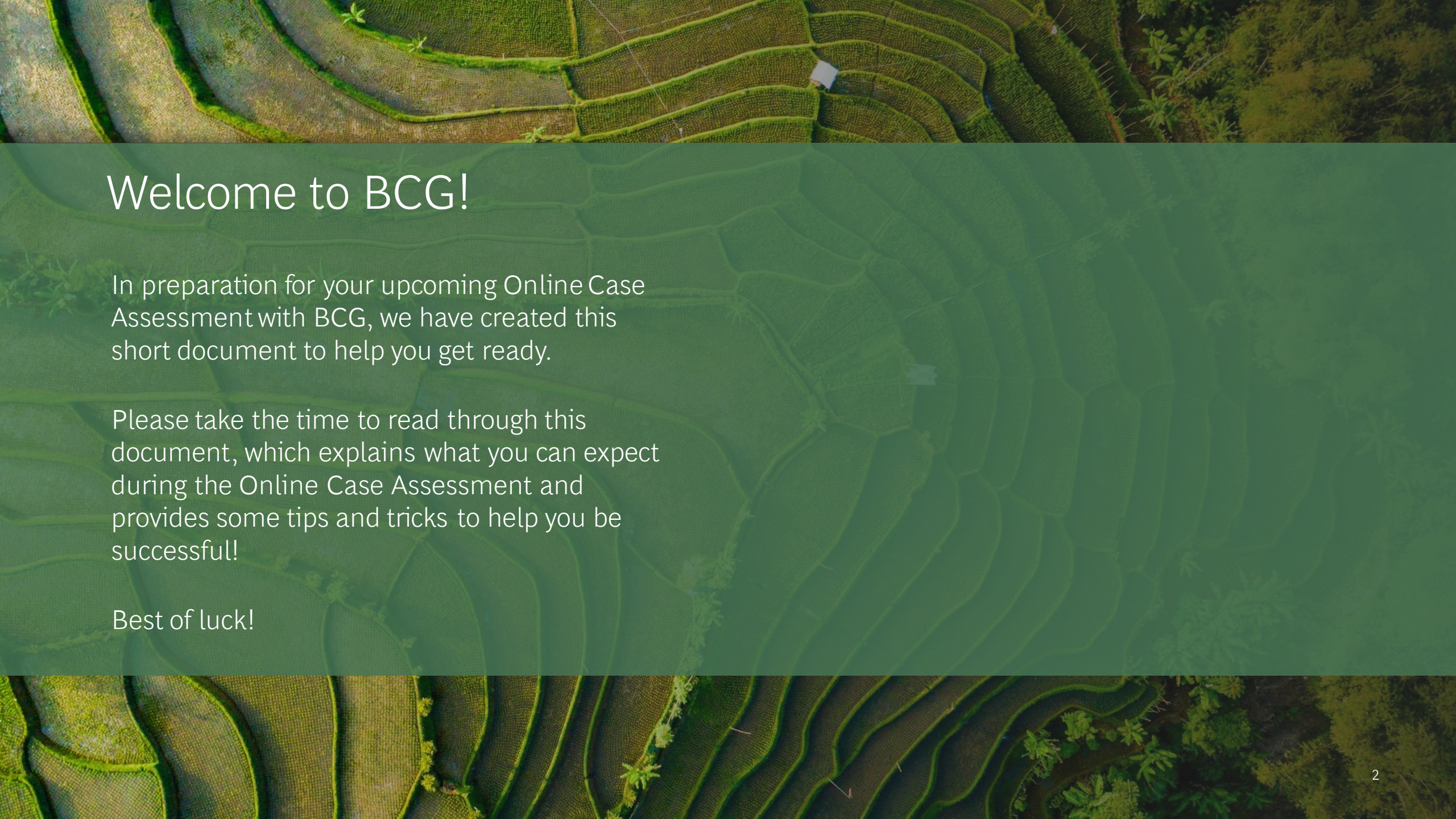
BCG Online Case Assessment

User reference guide & helpful tips



BCG

Beyond is
where we begin.

An aerial photograph of terraced rice fields, showing the intricate patterns of the terraces. The image is overlaid with a semi-transparent green layer that serves as a background for the text.

Welcome to BCG!

In preparation for your upcoming Online Case Assessment with BCG, we have created this short document to help you get ready.

Please take the time to read through this document, which explains what you can expect during the Online Case Assessment and provides some tips and tricks to help you be successful!

Best of luck!

An aerial photograph of a lush green forest. A narrow, winding stream flows through the center of the image, surrounded by dense trees and vegetation. The colors are vibrant greens and yellows, suggesting a healthy, natural environment.

What you can expect from BCG's Online Case Assessment

Format

100% online, taken from your home on your personal computer; conducted by our chatbot, Casey

Duration

~30 minutes: short introduction video + 25 min to complete the case + 1-min video recording at the end

Assessment Details

Case consists of 8-10 questions + a video recording at the end

Questions can be multiple choice, short answer, or fill-in

At the end, you will be asked to answer a question over video. You will have 1 minute to prepare, and 1 minute to record the video.

Example of the case interface (1 of 3)

The screenshot displays the BCG Practice Online Case Experience interface. At the top, the BCG logo is on the left, and the text "Practice Online Case Experience" is on the right, next to a clock icon showing 19:47. The main content area has a light gray background with a white box containing instructions: "have a stable internet connection as well as a calculator handy as you may have to do some calculations." Below this, another white box states: "This is a **timed section**. If you would like to take a break, please take it now and you can come back when you're ready. **Once you start**, you can take up to **20 minutes** to complete the section." A timestamp "24 Dec, 10:48 AM" is visible. To the right of the instructions is a green button labeled "I'm ready!". Below the instructions, a blue box contains a timer: "You have till 24 Dec, 11:08 AM to complete this section. 20 minutes from now ...". Below the timer, another blue box is titled "(Question 1 of 5)" and contains the text: "Our client is the world's second largest container shipping company by revenues. Last week, two of our competitors announced a merger that would create a joint entity larger than we are. Our client needs to figure out how to respond." Below the text, it asks: "Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?". A timestamp "24 Dec, 10:48 AM" is visible. At the bottom, there are four blue buttons with white text: "Make a study of our own revenues and costs to decide how we can maximize profit", "Determine how we can regain our position as second largest player", "Understand how the merger will affect us, then decide on an appropriate course of action", and "Look for a suitable merger partner as well".

Casey will guide you through the test questions, and give you relevant context as needed

Example of the case interface (2 of 3)

BCG Practice Online Case Experience 13:35

If our competitors increase their market share, they can influence pricing power, leading to a price war. If we have less market share, we are at the losing end of the pricing & market share bargain. Need to figure out how to counter this move.

Thanks. The most important consequence that we are concerned about is

State the 3 cost items that are likeliest to experience a significant percentage decrease due to the merger.

Cost of ship crew	Cost of finance personnel
Interest expense	Marketing spend
Cost of fuel	Taxes
Depreciation	IT costs
Port fees	

None of these

You will be asked some multiple-choice questions; please read the questions carefully

BCG Practice Online Case Experience 14:54

and you can come back when you're ready. Once you start, you can take up to 20 minutes to complete the section.

23 Dec, 10:29 AM

I'm ready!

You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section.

(Question 1 of 5)

Our client is the revenues. Last we would create a job out how to resp

Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?

A gentle reminder... You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section which is 15 minutes and 0 second from now ...

23 Dec, 10:33 AM

Reminder

You have 15 minutes and 0 second left to complete this section.

OK

... a study of our own es and costs to decide n can maximize profit

Determine how we can regain our position as second largest player

Understand how the merger will affect us, then decide on an appropriate course of action

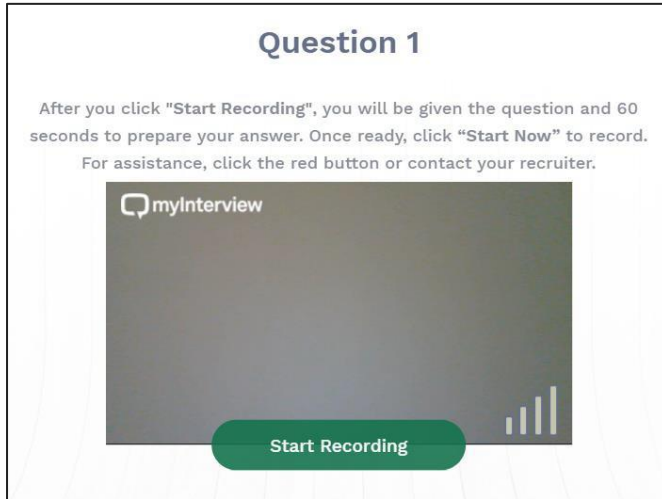
Look for a suitable merger partner as well

Casey will occasionally remind you of remaining time until the end of the test

You can also view the running countdown clock in the top right corner

Example of the case interface (3 of 3)

Start screen

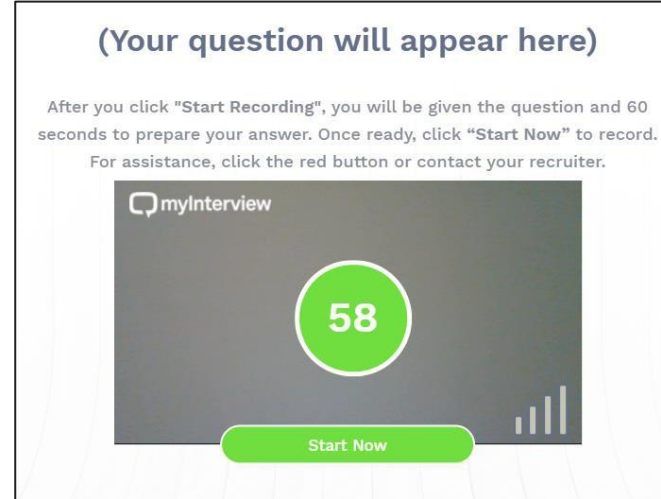


At the end, you will need to record a video of yourself

When prompted, please allow myInterview.com to use your microphone and camera

Click "Start Recording" to begin the process.

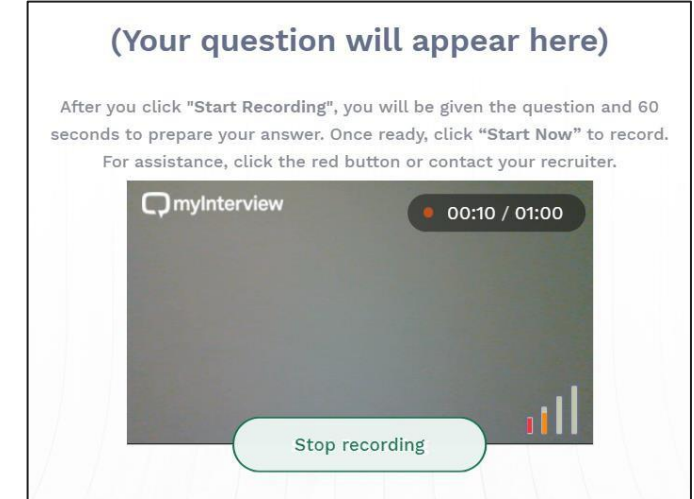
Preparing your answer (60 sec)



After you click "Start Recording", the question will appear. There will be a countdown to let you know how many seconds you have left.

The recording starts after the countdown runs out, or click "Start Now" to begin recording.

Recording your answer (60 sec)



Once recording starts, a timer on the top left will let you know how many seconds you have left to record.

An aerial photograph of a dark asphalt road with white dashed lines, curving through a dense, green forest. The road is seen from above, and the surrounding trees are thick and lush.

Tips to set you up for success before you take the online case assessment

We recommend that you complete this practice case prior to your formal assessment, to familiarize yourself with the format.

Note: the practice case is shorter than the real case and does not include the video recording. But it has the same level of the difficulty as the real assessment.

- You will have 25 mins to complete the assessment. Casey will help you keep track of time, however, please plan accordingly.
- You will not be able to go back and reference exhibits, review, or change previous answers.
- All answer submissions are final. You must work through the case in the order of questions asked. You will not receive your final score.
- You will have only 1 attempt to record your 1-min video at the end of the assessment:
- You will be given 1 min to prepare your answer, and 1 min to record your delivery via video
- Please refer to the following FAQs for additional technical information

Tips & tricks during the assessment: time management

The screenshot displays the BCG Practice Online Case Experience interface. At the top left is the BCG logo, and next to it is the text "Practice Online Case Experience". In the top right corner, there is a small circular icon with a clock face and the number "9:46" below it. The main content area shows a case study and two questions. The first question is titled "(Question 1 of 5)" and asks for an approach to solve a problem. A green button labeled "I'm ready!" is visible. Below the question, a green box contains the text "Make a study of our own revenues and costs to decide how we can maximize profit". A second question is titled "(Question 2 of 5)" and asks for the most important impact of a merger. A green button labeled "test" is visible. At the bottom, there are four blue buttons with text: "Increase in merged entity's advertising spend", "Reduction in our pricing power and market share", "Increase in the range of destinations offered by the merged entity", and "The total market share of the merged entity".

BCG Practice Online Case Experience

25 Dec, 10:29 AM

You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section. 20 minutes from now ...

(Question 1 of 5)

Our client is the world's second largest container shipping company by revenues. Last week, two of our competitors announced a merger that would create a joint entity larger than we are. Our client needs to figure out how to respond.

Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?

Make a study of our own revenues and costs to decide how we can maximize profit

25 Dec, 10:37 AM

Could you please explain your reasoning in 2-3 lines?

25 Dec, 10:37 AM

test

25 Dec, 10:38 AM

Understanding our revenues and costs is important. Let's think about the impact from our competitors' merger first.

(Question 2 of 5)

Which of the following potential impacts of the merger would be most important to determine, so that we can formulate a suitable response?

A gentle reminder... You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section which is 10 minutes and 0 second from now ...

25 Dec, 10:40 AM

Increase in merged entity's advertising spend

Reduction in our pricing power and market share

Increase in the range of destinations offered by the merged entity

The total market share of the merged entity

Countdown clock on the right corner helps you to track how much time left

Before every question, you'll see question number and how many questions left

Every 5 minutes you'll have a pop-up reminder on how much time left

Assumed knowledge & glossary of key terms

Remember, this is a 'real' case study assessment, you should **prepare for this test as you would a regular case study interview**. That means **some business knowledge** will be required, as well as some analytical problem solving - we strongly recommend that you practice case study interviews before attempting the test. In order to help get you started we have included an initial & non-exhaustive glossary of business terms below, to give you an idea of the kind of language that may be used in the assessment.

- Revenue/Sales: the total amount of money received by a business for providing goods and services. This is often calculated as the number of units sold multiplied by the price.
- Fixed costs: business costs that are not dependent on the amount of goods or services produced by the business. Fixed costs usually include things like rent and interest.
- Variable costs: business costs that change as the amount of goods and services produced by a business changes. Variable costs may include things like raw materials or delivery costs. Variable cost per unit refers to total variable costs divided by units sold.
- Gross profit: the income of a business remaining after the costs of production and distribution (typically, the variable costs associated with producing the goods or services) have been subtracted from revenue.
- Net profit: the income of a business given by revenue minus all costs and expenses that the business incurs.
- Market share: the portion of an industry controlled by a given business. A firm's market share by revenue is typically calculated as its revenue divided by the combined revenue of all businesses in the same industry.
- Complementary goods: products which tend to be consumed together share a beneficial relationship with other products (e.g. an iPhone and mobile applications). Thus, increasing demand for one tends to increase demand for the other.
- Substitute goods: products which can be used for the same or similar purposes. Substitute goods can be considered interchangeable (e.g. skim milk and semi-skim milk).
- Expected profit: The profit that a business expects to make, weighted by the probability of all potential profit outcomes. For example, if there is a 60% chance that a business will make \$100,000 on a deal, and 40% chance that it will lose \$50,000, then the expected profit on the deal is $60\% \times \$100,000 + 40\% \times (-\$50,000) = \$40,000$.



Frequently Asked Questions (1/3)

How do I access the test? What if I don't receive an invitation email?

An invitation email will be sent to you from our technology partner, Impress. Please follow the instructions on the invitation email to start the assessment.

If you do not receive the email, please check your junk/spam folder for an email from website@impress.ai.

If you still do not see an email, reach out to your recruiter and they will re-send you the link

What hardware and other technical requirements are needed to complete this test?

A webcam-enabled laptop and a calculator are both required for this test. Do not access the test on a mobile phone.

Please use Chrome, Firefox, or Opera as the web browser. Do not use Internet Explorer. Google Chrome is the preferred browser for this test. Please disable VPN.

Please ensure that you have a stable internet connection while taking the test, especially because you will need to record a video of yourself and the end.



Frequently Asked Questions (2/3)

Do I have to complete the test in one sitting?

Yes, you need to complete the test in one sitting, as the timer will continue to run even if you are logged out.

If you are interrupted, you can log back in using the same invitation email and password. You will be brought back to the same place where you left off, but time will have elapsed.

I can't see all of the question content in my test browser – what should I do?

You may find it useful to zoom out on your browser in order to fit all the text in one screen. (For instructions on how to do this in Chrome, [click here](#))

How do I troubleshoot if my webcam isn't properly connected to the technical platform for the video portion of the exam?

Your webcam should automatically connect to the platform. However, in the unlikely event that this occurs, please ensure that other applications that may access or interfere with your webcam (such as other videoconferencing apps) are switched off. If your browser continues to experience issues accessing your webcam, try rebooting, changing to another approved browser (Chrome, Firefox, Opera), or to another computer.

Do note that if the internet connection is slightly unstable, the video service may take up to 30 seconds to connect and initiate. If you continue to experience issues, please try again with another Internet connection.



Frequently Asked Questions (3/3)

What if a testing session is interrupted because of poor internet connection or accidental closure of the chat bot?

Click “Refresh” on your browser. You will not lose the progress that you have made and will be able to get back to the same question through the invitation link within 25 mins after the moment when your test began. All answers will be recorded in the platform. Delays can be minimized by ensuring that you have a stable internet connection.

My exhibits won't load / open in one of the questions – what do I do?

Please refresh the page if you face delays in loading either the exhibit or the bot (click on the refresh button on the browser, or highlight the weblink and press enter).

Will I know my score at the end of the interview?

No. Similar to a live or face-to-face case interview, you will not know how you scored in the Online Case Assessment. Note that scoring varies by question type, and each question may carry a different weight.

What do I do if I am unable to record the video portion?

While unlikely this will happen, we will still have your quantitative/general test results. We suggest you self-record your answer to the video recommendation prompt using your mobile phone or other device and send this recording to your recruiter.

A photograph of three hands holding a white rectangular card. The hands are of different skin tones: one is dark-skinned with a gold ring on the ring finger, and two are light-skinned. The card is held in the center of the frame. The background is a modern building with large glass windows and a dark metal frame. The text 'Good Luck!' is written in a green, sans-serif font on the card.

Good Luck!



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